

5-Month ROI & Budget Roadmap

Candidate: Matthew Linke | **Target:** Cloud Identity & Security Architect | **Market:** Vancouver/Portland

EXECUTION & BUDGET SNAPSHOT

MONTH	CERTIFICATION	VOUCHER COST	IMPACT	SALARY TARGET
Month 1	MS-102 (M365 Admin)	\$165	Intune/MDM Expertise	\$100k
Month 3	Security+ (SY0-701)	\$425*	Govt/Compliance	\$115k
Month 5	SC-300 (Cloud ID)	\$165	Identity Architect	\$130k+
TOTAL		\$755	ROI: ~60x Floor Increase	

MONTH 1: FOUNDATION

\$165 (Exam Replay: \$230)

MS-102: Microsoft 365 Administrator Associate

Converts 15 years of support experience into a modern "Cloud Admin" credential. Proves you can manage the full user lifecycle in ZoomInfo or Unitus-level environments.

Strategy: Use free MS Learn paths. Invest in Tutorials Dojo practice sets (\$20).

MONTH 3: COMPLIANCE

\$425 (*\$260 w/ .edu)

CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701)

The "Hard Requirement" for many local high-paying roles. Removes the HR filter for security-conscious organizations and government agencies in Vancouver.

Strategy: Use your Clark College .edu email for academic pricing (~\$260).

SC-300: Identity & Access Administrator

The elite specialized credential. Shifts your market value from "Device Management" to "Enterprise Security Architecture."

Strategy: Position as high-value architect for \$140k+ roles after certification.

BUDGETING TIPS FOR MATTHEW

- **Microsoft Exam Replay:** For \$230 (+\$65), you get 1 exam + 1 guaranteed retake. Highly recommended for high-stakes exams.
- **CompTIA Retake Bundle:** For \$474 (+\$49), you get the voucher + 1 retake. Cheaper than paying \$425 twice.
- **Free Training:** MS Learn and Professor Messer (YouTube) are your best zero-cost resources.